



Linnerud, Lee, Jakubicek & Melka Heritage

From Norway and Bohemia, to Wisconsin and Illinois.

Compiled August 2026

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Linnerud & Lee

From Hedmark to the Stockyards

The Generations

Generation o

Søren Sørensen

Born: ~1829, Norway

Spouse: Gubjør Olsdatter

- 1865 Census: Head of household at Gylterud farm, Vinger/Austmarka, Hedmark
- His mother Sigri Andersdatter (born ~1797) lived with the family — 5× great-grandmother
- Children: Anne (~1854), Sigvard/Sigvart (~1858), Ole (~1860), Gunder (~1863)
- Father of Sigvart S. Lee (born Sigvard Sørensen)

Gubjør Olsdatter

Born: ~1824, Norway

Spouse: Søren Sørensen

- Mother of Sigvart S. Lee (born Sigvard Sørensen)
- Grew up at Gylterud farm, same parish as the Arneson family

Arne

From: Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

- Father of Berthea Arnesdatter (Berthea S. Lee) — 3× great-grandmother
- Full name unknown — known only from Berthea's patronymic surname 'Arnesdatter' (daughter of Arne)
- Grew up at Kjærret farm, Vinger parish — same area as the Sørensen family at Gylterud
- No further records found

Anne Gundersdatter

From: Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

Spouse: Arne

- Mother of Berthea Arnesdatter (Berthea S. Lee)
- Known from Berthea's notes — 'Mother: Anne Gundersdatter'
- No dates or further records found

Generation 1

Anders Pedersen

From: Norway

- Andrew's birth father — named on 1885 baptism record
- Nothing else known

Marthe Arnesdatter

From: Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

- Andrew's mother — an unmarried servant girl
- 1891 Census: listed as domestic servant; Andrew listed as 'the servant girl's son'
- Later married Martin Olsen and lived at the Linnerud farm

Sigvart S. Lee

Born: December 31, 1859, Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

Died: March 10, 1943, Manchester, Boone County, IL

Spouse: Berthea Arneson

Occupation: Farmer

Immigrated: 1885

Ship: Juno

Burial: Borgen Cemetery, Clinton, Rock County, WI

- Changed surname from Sørensen to 'Lee' between 1900-1910
- Owned farm in Manchester Township, Boone County, IL for 30+ years
- Father: Søren Sørensen; Mother: Gubjør Olsdatter
- Married Berthea September 8, 1892 in Dane County, Wisconsin

Berthea S. Lee

Born: ~1861-1862, Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

Died: September 27, 1921, Boone County, IL

Spouse: Sigvart S. Lee

- Father: Arne; Mother: Anne Gundersdatter
- Grew up at Kjærret farm — SAME PARISH as Sigvart's family at Gylterud farm
- They were neighbors in Norway and found each other again in America

Generation 2

Andrew Olaus Linnerud

Born: March 10, 1885, Vinger, Hedmark, Norway

Died: December 4, 1948, Chicago (7306 S. Talman Avenue)

Spouse: Anna Gudrun Lee

Occupation: Blacksmith → Railroad Mechanic → Carpenter

Immigrated: 1906

Ship: SS Caronia

Burial: Bergen Cemetery (Jefferson Prairie), Clinton, Rock County, WI

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- Born to an unmarried servant — 'the servant girl's son'
 - Took his surname from the Linnerud farm where he grew up
 - Married Anna Gudrun Lee in 1911, Boone County, IL (she was 18, he was 26)
 - WWI Draft Card (1917-1918): registered in Boone County, IL. Medium build, medium height, dark hair, blue eyes. Listed wife Annie Linnerud as relative. Age 32, married farmer — registered but almost certainly never served.
 - Obituary: Chicago Tribune, Dec 6, 1948 — funeral at Bergen, Wisconsin
 - 4 children: Grace, Albert (died age 20), Evelyn, Lyle

Anna Gudrun Lee

Born: March 23, 1893, Manchester, Boone County, Illinois

Died: April 11, 1987

Spouse: Andrew Olaus Linnerud

Occupation: Homemaker

Burial: Jefferson Prairie Cemetery, Clinton, Rock County, WI

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- Listed as 'Annie Sorenson' in 1900 Census (family still using patronymic)
 - Parents: Sigvart S. Lee & Berthea (Arneson)
 - Lived to age 94
 - Born in Illinois to Norwegian parents

Their 4 children: Grace Mable Othelia (1911-1998), Albert Siegel (1913-1933, killed in storm at 19), Evelyn Bernice/Conway (1915-1969), Lyle Andrew (1922-2015)

Generation 3

Lyle Andrew Linnerud

Born: August 30, 1922, Chicago, Illinois

Died: August 29, 2015

Spouse: Helen Marie Jakubicek

Occupation: Printer Foreman, R.R. Donnelley & Sons (per family); USCG WWII veteran

Burial: Abraham Lincoln National Cemetery

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- Died ONE DAY before his 93rd birthday
 - US Coast Guard WWII — enlisted December 1942, age 20
 - Assigned to USS Admiral E.W. Eberle (AP-123) in March 1945
 - Seaman 1st Class, 41 months service, \$66/month
 - Traveled 85,000 miles in one year — Atlantic 6x, Pacific 8x, Panama Canal 2x
 - Survived a plane crash on the ship (March 25, 1945, Manus Island — Navy pilot lost control during aerobatics, 2 killed in plane, 1 dead + 5 wounded on ship) and a floating mine in the Pacific
 - Japan surrendered while he was at sea (August 14, 1945)
 - Honorably discharged May 1946
 - Married Helen Marie Jakubicek on January 20, 1951
 - 5 children: Alan (firstborn), Calvin, twins Cary & Cheryl, Andrea (youngest)
 - Valedictorian of Gage Park High School, 1940
 - Post-war career: Printer Foreman at R.R. Donnelley & Sons, Chicago (per family oral history, not yet confirmed in public records)
 - Author of memoir: 'The Rime of an Ancient Mariner'

Helen Marie Jakubicek

Born: September 14, 1925, Chicago, Illinois

Died: April 5, 2010, Illinois

Spouse: Lyle Andrew Linnerud

Burial: Abraham Lincoln National Cemetery, Sec 5, Site 556

- Parents: Thomas Joseph Jakubicek (b.1886, Moravia) & Marie E. Melka (b.1896, Bohemia)
- Grew up speaking Czech at the dinner table on Chicago's South Side
- Known above all for her contagious JOY — her son Cary's eulogy opened with that single word
- Kept Bible verses around the house including by the ironing board: 'The Joy of the Lord is my strength' (Nehemiah 8:10)
- Member of Maranatha's 'Merry Heart's Club' — delivered encouragement to the sick
- Bohemian cooking was her specialty — incredible desserts, Joy dish soap as a secret ingredient
- Loved games: horseshoes, ping pong, bowling, bean bags, cards — and she won
- Her son Cary served as church organist for 20+ years including the Old Cadet Chapel at West Point — credits Helen for his love of music
- Married Lyle January 20, 1951 in Winnebago County, IL
- 5 children: Alan (firstborn), Calvin, twins Cary & Cheryl, Andrea (youngest)
- Died during Easter season, April 5, 2010 — 'Let us remember Mom every time we laugh or hear the word JOY'
- Full story: see Helen — A Merry Heart on the Jakubicek & Melka family page

Stories & Historical Notes

The Servant Girl's Son

In the 1891 Norwegian census, six-year-old Anders Olaus is recorded not by his name but by his status: 'tjenestejentens Søn' — the servant girl's son. His mother Marthe was an unmarried domestic worker. His birth father Anders Pedersen is named only on the baptism record and then vanishes from history. Marthe later married Martin Olsen, and the family lived on a farm called Linnerud — Farm #52 in Mo Parish, Nord-Odal. When the boy grew up and sailed for America, he took the farm's name as his own. The servant girl's son became Andrew Olaus Linnerud.

Tjenestejentens Søn — the servant girl's son.

85,000 Miles at Sea

In December 1942, at age 20, Lyle Linnerud enlisted in the U.S. Coast Guard. By March 1945, he was assigned to the USS Admiral E.W. Eberle (AP-123), a 610-foot troop transport — nearly a city block long — armed with four 5-inch guns, ten twin 40mm guns, and six 20mm guns. He was assigned to one of the 20mm guns. His duties: deckhand handling 3-inch hawsers while mooring and unmooring, chipping rust, painting, mess cook serving food to soldiers and crew, and lookout observer.

The crow's nest was something special. Attached near the top of the foremast, 100 feet above the ocean, it was the size of an outdoor garbage can with a lid to keep out the weather. Furnished with binoculars and a telephone to the bridge, you could see 15 miles to the horizon — and the curvature of the earth. 'Smoke on the horizon at 2 o'clock,' Lyle would report, then the smokestack, then the bridge, then the hull. The ladder climb was always white-knuckle time, with the ship rolling side to side and the arc growing wider the higher you climbed.

On March 25, 1945, at Manus Island, a Navy pilot doing aerobatics lost control and deliberately nosed his plane into the ship's side to avoid crashing into the main deck full of troops watching. Both occupants of the plane were killed. One crew member on the ship died and five were wounded. Lyle was there.

One of the bow lookouts spotted a floating mine directly in their path. Quick action by the helmsman avoided it. The crew circled the mine — about 4 to 5 feet across — and detonated it with a twin 40mm gun. A disaster averted.

On July 25, 1945, the Eberle departed Marseilles with 5,000 troops bound for the invasion of Japan. Thirty-two days and 16,000 miles later — through the Mediterranean, past Gibraltar, across the Atlantic, through the Caribbean, the Panama Canal, and across the Pacific — they reached Manila. Two-thirds around the earth at 22 knots. During this voyage, atomic bombs fell on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9). On August 14, Emperor Hirohito surrendered. 'The war ended with much joy aboard the ship and worldwide.'

In one year, the Eberle traveled 85,000 miles. They crossed the Atlantic 6 times, the Pacific 8 times, and the Panama Canal twice. Ports of call: Le Havre, Marseilles, Naples, Norfolk, Port of Spain, Panama City, Ulithi, Manila, Naha (Okinawa), Seoul, Nagoya (twice), Los Angeles (twice), Seattle (three times), and Tacoma.

In May 1946, Lyle was honorably discharged as Seaman 1st Class after 41 months of service at \$66 per month. He titled his memoir 'The Rime of an Ancient Mariner' and ended it: 'The Angels, Goodness and Mercy, have followed me all the days of my life. Praise the Lord. Thanks for the memories.'

I joined the Coast Guard to see the sea and what did I see? I saw the sea.

Albert — Killed in the Storm

Albert Siegel Linnerud was 19 years old and working as a printer in Chicago when he was killed on June 4, 1933. The family story says a roof piece fell on him while driving with his girlfriend, who survived. The Belvidere Daily Republican from June 8, 1933 tells a different story: 'KILLED IN STORM' — Albert died when a factory wall collapsed during a violent storm. He was buried three days later at Bergen Cemetery in Wisconsin, next to where his father Andrew would be buried fifteen years later. His gravestone says simply: SON.

SON.



Jakubicek & Melka

From Moravia to Pilsen

The Generations

Generation 0

The parents of George Jakubicek and Ludvik Melka remain unknown. No records have been found beyond what Thomas and Marie's immigration and death documents provide. The Jakubicek line traces back to Moravia and the Melka line to Bohemia — both regions of what is now the Czech Republic.

Generation 1

George Jakubicek

From: Mähren (Moravia)

- Known only from Thomas's death record
- Father of Thomas Joseph Jakubicek
- Both he and wife Marie were from Moravia

Marie Jakubicek

From: Mähren (Moravia)

Spouse: George Jakubicek

- Mother of Thomas Joseph Jakubicek
- Known from Thomas's death record — both parents from Moravia
- No further details known

Ludvik Melka

From: Czech Republic

Spouse: Klara Marc/Marč

- Marie's father — from Ancestry tree match
- Wife Klara's maiden name: Marc or Marč (from death record)
- Father of Marie E. Melka Jakubicek

Klara Marc

From: Czech Republic

Spouse: Ludvik Melka

- Mother of Marie E. Melka Jakubicek
- Maiden name: Marc or Marč — recorded on Marie's death record
- Confirmed from Find A Grave: Mary (Marie) Jakubicek née Melka, parents listed as Ludvig Melka and Clara Marc
- No further details known

Generation 2

Thomas Joseph Jakubicek

Born: December 6, 1886, Lipov, Moravia (now Czech Republic)

Died: January 3, 1963, Chicago

Spouse: Marie Melka

Occupation: Printer → Laborer → Machine Operator (Storkline Furniture Co.)

Immigrated: 1903 (age 17)

Ship: SS Kronprinz Wilhelm

Burial: Bohemian National Cemetery, Chicago — Lot 615, Section 34

- Arrived Ellis Island May 6, 1903
- Single boarder in 1920 — took 19 years to marry
- Married Mary Melka on August 12, 1922
- Naturalized September 26, 1928 — 25 years after arrival!
- Worked at Storkline Furniture Corp — a National Historic Landmark factory

Marie E. Melka

Born: ~November 19, 1896, Meremice, Bohemia, Czechoslovakia

Died: March 19, 1989, Crestwood, Cook County, IL

Spouse: Thomas Joseph Jakubicek

Immigrated: 1913 (age 17)

Ship: SS Kronprinz Wilhelm

Burial: Bohemian National Cemetery — Lot 615, Section 34 (same plot as Thomas)

- Father: Ludvik Melka; Mother: Klara Marc/Marč
- Sailed on the SAME FAMOUS SHIP as Thomas, a decade later
- Lived to age 92
- 3 children: Helen (married Lyle Linnerud), Marie/Mary (married Novak), Tommy

Generation 3

Lyle Andrew Linnerud

Born: August 30, 1922, Chicago, Illinois

Died: August 29, 2015

Spouse: Helen Marie Jakubicek

Occupation: Printer Foreman; US Coast Guard WWII veteran

Burial: Abraham Lincoln National Cemetery

- Died one day before his 93rd birthday
- US Coast Guard WWII — enlisted December 1942, served 41 months, traveled 85,000 miles
- Crossed the Atlantic 6x, Pacific 8x, survived a floating mine
- Japan surrendered while he was at sea (August 14, 1945)
- Married Helen Marie Jakubicek on January 20, 1951
- 5 children: Alan, Calvin, twins Cary & Cheryl, Andrea (youngest)
- Author of memoir: 'The Rime of an Ancient Mariner'
- Full WWII story available on the Linnerud & Lee family page

Helen Marie Jakubicek

Born: September 14, 1925, Chicago, Illinois

Died: April 5, 2010, Illinois

Spouse: Lyle Andrew Linnerud

- Parents: Thomas Joseph Jakubicek (b.1886, Moravia) & Marie E. Melka (b.1896, Bohemia)
- Married Lyle Andrew Linnerud on January 20, 1951 — Norwegian meets Czech on Chicago's South Side
- 5 children: Alan (firstborn), Calvin, twins Cary & Cheryl, Andrea (youngest)
- Known for her contagious JOY — the defining word used in her eulogy
- Kept Bible verses all around the house, including by the ironing board: 'The Joy of the Lord is my strength' (Nehemiah 8:10)
- Bohemian dishes and desserts were her specialty — used Joy dish soap as a 'secret ingredient'
- Member of Maranatha's 'Merry Heart's Club' — delivered hearts of joy to the sick
- Loved games: horseshoes, ping pong, bowling, bean bags, cards
- Her son Cary became a church organist for 20+ years, including at the Old Cadet Chapel at West Point — he credits Helen for instilling his love of music
- Died April 5, 2010, during the Easter season — celebrated as a season of joy and resurrection
- Eulogy delivered by son Cary: 'Let us all try to maintain a joyful heart and to remember Mom every time we laugh or hear the word JOY!'

Stories & Historical Notes

Helen — A Merry Heart

Helen Marie Jakubicek was born on September 14, 1925, the daughter of Thomas and Marie Jakubicek at their home on West 18th Street in Chicago's Bohemian neighborhood. She grew up speaking Czech at the dinner table, eating her mother's Bohemian dishes, and absorbing a culture of warmth, community, and faith.

If Thomas and Marie's story is about endurance — crossing an ocean alone, waiting 19 years to marry, building a life from nothing — Helen's story is about what gets made from that foundation. She had one defining characteristic, so central to who she was that her son Cary named it in the very first line of her eulogy: JOY.

'Joy is gladness of the heart or rejoicing,' he said. 'Mom possessed an abundant and infectious joy that made all of our lives more enjoyable.' She kept Bible verses around the house — by the ironing board, above the sink — including her favorite: 'The Joy of the Lord is my strength' (Nehemiah 8:10). She was a member of her church's 'Merry Heart's Club,' delivering encouragement to the sick. When her son went through Beast Barracks at West Point in 1975 — grueling summer training where plebes were forbidden to smile — he later told her that her lessons in humor kept him going. He even got caught smiling once, and was punished by having to laugh for a full minute under a dirty laundry bag.

Helen married Lyle Andrew Linnerud on January 20, 1951 — a Norwegian farmer's grandson from Wisconsin, meeting a Czech printer's daughter from Chicago. They had five children: Alan, Calvin, twins Cary and Cheryl, and their youngest, Andrea. Helen raised them on Bohemian cooking — her specialty was incredible desserts, and she reportedly used Joy dish soap as a secret ingredient in a way that became family legend. She loved horseshoes, ping pong, bowling, bean bags, and cards — and she won at all of them.

She died on April 5, 2010, during the Easter season — which Cary noted was fitting for a woman whose life was a testament to resurrection and hope. Her son, who had served as church organist for over twenty years including at the Old Cadet Chapel at West Point, credited her with teaching him to love music.

Two immigrants sailed on the Kronprinz Wilhelm and found each other in Chicago. Their daughter became the heart of a family — laughing, cooking, winning at horseshoes, and filling every room she entered with joy.

Let us all try to maintain a joyful heart and to remember Mom every time we laugh or hear the word JOY.

The Same Ship, A Decade Apart

In 1903, seventeen-year-old Thomas Jakubicek boarded the SS Kronprinz Wilhelm in Bremen, Germany, bound for Ellis Island. Ten years later, in 1913, seventeen-year-old Marie Melka boarded the exact same ship from the exact same port. Both were Czech teenagers leaving everything behind. They didn't know each other on those crossings. But they would find each other in Chicago's Pilsen neighborhood — the heart of Bohemian America — and marry in 1922. The Kronprinz Wilhelm itself would become a German warship in WWI, captured by the Americans, and scrapped. But the two teenagers it carried became a family.

The same ship. The same port. A decade apart. They found each other in Chicago.

Bohemian National Cemetery

Thomas and Marie are buried together at Bohemian National Cemetery on Chicago's North Side — the cultural heart of the Czech-American community. Founded in 1877 as a 'freethought' cemetery (in contrast to Catholic cemeteries), it became the final resting place for generations of Czech immigrants. Thomas, who arrived knowing no one, who lived as a boarder for 19 years before marrying, rests there permanently in Lot 615, Section 34.